LabRats — data processing and security summary

4 November 2026 · Development implementation; hosted activation and school approval pending

Purpose and responsibility. LabRats supports Chemistry and Applied Science revision in one school. One student account works across subjects; question and self-assessed flashcard progress remain separate. Adaptive N/A–E guidance prioritises revision; it is not an exam grade or a basis for significant automated decisions. The school/trust must confirm its controller role, lawful basis, privacy information and DPIA outcome.

Data minimisation. Students use random adjective–animal usernames and generated, non-deliverable @students.invalid identifiers. No student name, real email, date of birth or phone number is requested. Supabase Auth holds password hashes and authentication records. Application records include account IDs, roles, class/subject memberships, login times, question/card versions, timestamps, marks and reveal/retry flags. Selected answers and free-text responses are excluded from account storage and uploads. Staff email addresses and administrative activity are processed. Retention extensions record an administrator, reason and expiry; reasons should contain no sensitive information. These records are pseudonymous personal data, not anonymous data. Any school-held identity mapping needs separate protection.

Access and security. No public registration is intended. Administrators invite staff; teachers privately issue batch-created student credentials. First/reset passwords require replacement; the agreed minimum is ten characters. Database row-level security and server checks restrict students to their own history and teachers to assigned classes and subjects; administrators manage the school. Resets revoke sessions. Privileged keys remain server-side; browsers receive public configuration only. HTTPS protects network transport. Marks are client-reported revision evidence, not tamper-proof assessment results.

Browser and external processing. Account sessions, metadata caches and offline queues use tab-scoped storage with memory fallback. Responses stay in page memory. Unsynced work can be lost when a tab/storage is lost; sign-out clears account caches and warns about pending work. Guest question history is browser-local; guest flashcard results are memory-only. Optional videos/links contact external providers; user-initiated question-report email drafts may contain answers and identify the sender. Supabase and the website host also process technical/security logs. Database region and all processing/transfer arrangements require confirmation.

Agreed retention. Students: two calendar years from first successful login; never-used accounts: 90 days from creation, with weekly deletion within seven further days. Administrators may document an extension or delete earlier; no advance student warning is planned. Deletion removes Auth accounts, memberships and both learning histories. Staff access is revoked on recorded departure, with handover and pack transfer; deletion is due after 23 days for weekly completion within 30. Invitation acceptance is capped at seven days (provider codes may expire sooner); abandoned invitation accounts are deleted within 30 days. Minimal audit/cleanup records, including pseudonymous staff actor references, are retained 12 months, with weekly removal. Existing accounts are excluded from automation pending review.

Operational boundaries and launch actions. Retention migration, scheduling and explicit enablement are required; school failure-alert delivery remains unconfigured. Optional GitHub Actions monitoring reads job status and can notify a school-approved endpoint. Local automated tests do not establish legal compliance or verify hosted settings. Before real-student rollout: complete contracts/transfers and supplier backup/log retention review; confirm staff MFA, admin ownership, secure credential disposal, rights/incident procedures and deletion after backup restoration; verify deployed permissions and resolve the deferred guest/account navigation issue. Provider backups/logs, school identity mappings and downloaded exports require separate retention procedures.